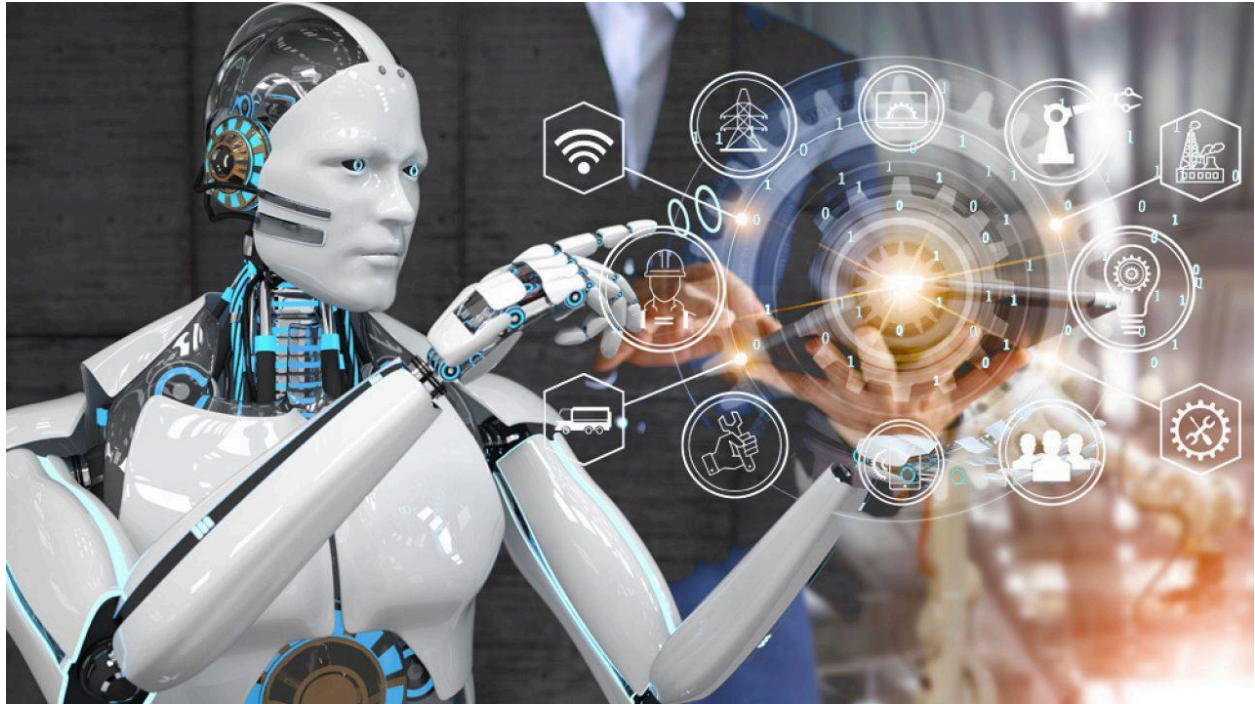




2022 IoT Predictions – How IoT Devices Are Set To Power Businesses into The New Normal Era

The recent pandemic made history, being named as the deadliest outbreak in American history, and indeed, the world was not prepared for it.

Never before has the world as a whole faced a strange phenomenon that made such a significant impact that completely shifted the culture of working and studying from home as the new norm. The shadow of COVID-19 has done its fair share of transformation, especially in the way we work, live, and think.

Thus, making this the best chance to explore opportunities in every area and emerging technologies. With the recent advancement and modification of the Internet of Things (IoT), how has it played its role in shaping the new normal?

What is the Internet of Things (IoT)?

Connected via the internet, IoT devices come in many shapes and forms, such as sensors, software, and other technologies used to collect data. Aside from exchanging data with other devices and systems, it will also analyze and store the data that will help provide companies with actionable insights on their systems and processes.

As the world continues to rely on technologies, the recent pandemic has gotten the governments, organizations, and healthcare sectors to lean towards the IoT to fight and stop the pandemic from spreading globally.

Virtualization has also formed the core base of connectivity, shortening the distance between remote workers.

IoT-driven changes have been one of the major reasons industries can remain operational and viable despite a socially-distanced and locked-down world. In this article, let's dive into the sea of possibilities and discuss the many ways IoT has helped businesses better navigate this new norm.

Voice Assistants



Amidst the pandemic season, virtual is the modern craze.

"Hey, Siri" is the phrase we all know too well as the first voice assistant to reach a broad audience, followed by Cortana and Alexa. With the rise of virtual assistants, they have played a significant role in various industries to help businesses and personal life go thrice as efficiently.

Recent [studies](#) showed 77% of respondents agreeing to increase their use of voice technology in the next 12 months, while 57% already use voice commands on complex tasks at least once a week.

From smart speakers to IoT devices in mobile apps, homes, cars, and call centers, people are starting to talk to devices and apps the same way they speak to each other. There is absolutely no doubt that the

future of business and operations lie in the virtual workforce, and because of that, voice AI continues to make strides in every area of our lives.

Wearables And Sensors



Smart technology has done a tremendous job in improving our lives, especially when it comes to wearables such as smart wrist bands and earbuds. Unlike traditional watches, they are designed to tell time as well as receive and reply to messages, answer calls, fitness trackers, synchronize calendars, GPS navigation, and many more.

In the past year, a myriad of IoT-based devices and wearables were introduced to provide good results in terms of accuracy when diagnosing and monitoring patients' symptoms such as heart rate, respiratory rate, and temperature.

According to [Urte Jakimaviciute](#), the Senior Director of Market Research at Global Data, wearables' ability to monitor sleep patterns, activities, and heart rates may be the game-changer in helping the world combat the spread of COVID-19.

IoT-based Workspaces



When it comes to the workplace, the most vital thing within any company is to ensure that the working environment provided for its people is safe and secure. Thus, bringing us to the idea of a smart building that involves equipment and appliances such as cameras, surveillance systems, lighting fixtures, and many others.

IoT in a working environment has brought many inventions that have successfully elevated workplace safety to a whole new level.

For example, air quality is one of the biggest concerns in companies due to the COVID-19 pandemic since it is a respiratory disease. Thus, implementing IoT sensors that can detect tiny harmful particles in the air is crucial.

Companies worldwide have managed to improve working settings, monitor environmental conditions, employees' physical health, help prevent accidents, and increase the productivity of their people by simply incorporating IoT technology into the organizations.

The New Golden Age in Tech

Whether we like it or not, IoT is deeply entwined into our lives. The pandemic has definitely played a major role in accelerating the adoption further. The urge to change and adopt it will not only save us from any future pandemic but also in electricity and many other resources. As IoT becomes

indispensable in our daily lives, it will continue to help us solve some of the world's biggest challenges which can only happen if we work together towards similar goals.

Also Read: [We Asked 5 M'sian Tech Companies If They'd Continue WFH – Here's What They Said](#)